

Tetracaine Hydrochloride Ophthalmic, 0.5%

(Altacaine, Tetcaine, TetraVisc)

I. Classification – Local Anesthetic, ophthalmic

II. Action(s)

- Inhibits Na ion channels, preventing generation and conduction of nerve impulse

III. Indication(s)

- Eye pain due to tear gas, chemical exposure, abrasion or foreign body
- Prior to Morgan Lens irrigation

IV. Contraindications

- Known Hypersensitivity or adverse reaction
- Contact Lenses (must remove first)

V. Precautions

- Caution in cardiac disease (heart block, abnormal rhythm) or hyperthyroidism

VI. Drug interactions

- No known significant drug interactions

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 2 drops in affected eye every 5 minutes, max 3 doses
- Instill drops in to retracted lower eye lid

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- >2 y/o: instill 1 drop in affected eye every 5 minutes, max 3 doses
- > 12 y/o see adult dosage
- Instill drop in to retracted lower eye lid

IX. Onset

- 30 seconds

X. Duration

- 10 – 20 minutes

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Transient burning or stinging in eye
- Ocular irritation, redness, chemosis, tearing, transient blurring of vision
- Prolonged use may cause corneal opacification, delayed healing, keratitis, ulceration

XII. Other Notes

- Remove Contact Lenses prior to administration
- Do not touch dropper tip to any surface
- Instruct patient to not touch eye after administration
- Prolonged repeated use can cause serious complication as stated above